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Re: Itamar Amsalem

To Whom It May Concern,

I am happy to recommend Itamar, whom I directly supervised during his internship at Adrestia. I work in quantitative research and engineering, with a background in mathematics and computer science. Itamar worked with me primarily on the development of an RFQ engine, where many of the questions we faced resembled classical execution-over-time problems: in our case, how to hedge a position as liquidity and market conditions evolve.

Clearly, I am unable to go into great detail about the projects Itamar worked on, but one aspect of his work illustrates the type of contribution he made. Itamar spent considerable time rapidly implementing and testing different machine-learning approaches within our RFQ work, including random forests and gradient-boosted trees. He was particularly comfortable taking an idea, turning it into something we could test, and getting results in front of us quickly.

This working style was also what stood out most to me about Itamar. He had an unusual willingness, particularly for an intern, to act in the face of uncertainty. At times I had to slow him down, redirect him, or push him to think more carefully about what an implementation was actually doing. But I consider the underlying instinct a real strength. Research often moves forward by doing: implement an idea, run the experiment, learn something, and use that information to decide what to do next. Itamar created that kind of forward motion very naturally.

Like any university intern, Itamar still has considerable room to develop the judgment, organization, and technical depth that come with professional experience. What is harder to teach, in my view, is the confidence to engage with an unfamiliar problem rather than wait until every step has been prescribed. Itamar already has that instinct. As he learns when to pair it with greater patience and deliberation, I think it can become a considerable strength.

Itamar was an outstanding intern. He did what I expected of him and, in several important ways, more than that. He brought energy to the project, consistently helped us turn questions into experiments, and was a valuable part of the team. I would gladly work with him again and am happy to recommend him. Please feel free to contact me if I can provide any additional information regarding Itamar or his work with us.

Sincerely,

Jesse Racicot
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